

PROSPER AWUNI

IT Cyber Security Specialist | Microsoft Sentinel and Defender Expert | Incident Response and Vulnerability Management

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified IT Cyber Security Specialist with over five years of experience designing, integrating, and managing complex cyber security controls across enterprise infrastructure and cloud environments. I have strong hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel (Security Information and Event Management - SIEM) using Kusto Query Language (KQL) for threat hunting, detection engineering, and security posture improvement, as well as Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), and the full Microsoft 365 Defender suite deployed across an 8,000-user estate. I bring proven capability in Incident Response, Threat Monitoring, and Vulnerability Management aligned to the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) 800-61 framework and MITRE ATT&CK methodology. I am skilled at advising technical infrastructure teams on security-focused designs and at translating complex security risks into clear, actionable guidance for both technical and non-technical audiences. I am ready to take ownership of cyber security engineering and architecture within a global organisation and to drive continuous improvement in security posture across infrastructure and cloud environments.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Threat Hunting:** Microsoft Sentinel with KQL (detection rules, threat hunting, workbook development); CrowdStrike Falcon LogScale NG-SIEM; Splunk / Search Processing Language (SPL)
- **Endpoint and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender; CrowdStrike Falcon EDR - Expert level
- **Identity and Access Management:** Microsoft Entra ID / Azure Active Directory (AD), Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), Public Key Infrastructure (PKI), Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, Group Policy, BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Endpoint Management:** Microsoft Intune, Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM); Group Policy administration
- **Incident Response:** NIST 800-61 incident lifecycle, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, root cause analysis, containment, eradication and post-incident review
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS); risk-based prioritisation and remediation tracking
- **Security Architecture:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus; security design review and advisory
- **Email and Network Security:** Mimecast email security gateway; Check Point Harmony firewall; Web Application Firewall (WAF)
- **Automation and Scripting:** PowerShell scripting, Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 - Present*

- Take ownership of cyber security engineering and architecture across UAL's global IT environment, advising the Infrastructure Engineering and Operations teams on security-focused designs, hardening standards, and risk remediation.
- Administer and continuously develop Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM) detection rules, KQL threat-hunting queries, workbooks, and SOAR playbooks; operate Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender across the 8,000-user estate.

- Lead Incident Response activities following the NIST 800-61 methodology: triage, containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review; produce clear incident reports for technical and senior non-technical stakeholders.
- Manage the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, translating technical findings into risk-prioritised remediation plans and tracking progress to closure.
- Administer Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory) including Conditional Access policy design, MFA enforcement, SSO configuration, PKI management, and identity governance.
- Manage Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, Group Policy, and Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policy sets to enforce security baselines across Windows, macOS, iOS, and Android device fleets.
- Oversee CrowdStrike Falcon EDR and NG-SIEM, Mimecast email gateway, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to maintain layered defence across endpoint, email, and privileged access vectors.
- Lead security architecture reviews for infrastructure and cloud projects, ensuring designs align to NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements.
- Deliver security awareness training and phishing simulations; produce security posture metrics and board-level reporting for senior stakeholders.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) - Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

- Deployed and operated Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across the 8,000-user estate, configuring detection policies, alert rules, and automated response actions.
- Developed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel SIEM detection rules, KQL threat-hunting queries, and incident response playbooks, reducing mean time to detect and respond to security events.
- Managed Entra ID Conditional Access, MFA, and SSO policies; administered Active Directory, Group Policy, and PKI to enforce identity security controls aligned to Zero Trust principles.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Tenable.io and AppCheck, produced remediation reports for infrastructure teams, and tracked progress against agreed Service Level Agreements (SLAs).
- Supported Incident Response investigations into malware infections, phishing campaigns, and identity compromise; performed root cause analysis and recommended corrective controls.
- Administered Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM to enforce device compliance baselines and application protection policies.
- Advised on security architecture for cloud and on-premises infrastructure projects, ensuring alignment to ISO 27001, CIS Controls, and Cyber Essentials Plus frameworks.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) - IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

- Managed Windows Server 2019/2022 infrastructure including Active Directory, DNS, DHCP, and Group Policy, applying security hardening standards across server and endpoint environments.
- Configured and maintained Azure Active Directory, MFA, SSO, and Intune MDM/MAM policies, supporting identity security and device compliance in a hybrid cloud environment.
- Performed vulnerability scanning and managed remediation activities in line with ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus requirements, maintaining the security posture of the SaaS platform.
- Managed PKI and security certificate lifecycle across infrastructure components; supported secure web and API gateway configurations.
- Assisted with SIEM log analysis and security incident triage, escalating findings and contributing to post-incident reviews.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and operationalised a Microsoft Sentinel SIEM environment with KQL-based detection rules and SOAR playbooks, enabling proactive threat hunting and reducing manual alert investigation effort.
- Deployed and maintained Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI, M365 Defender) across 8,000 users, establishing enterprise-wide XDR capability and achieving consolidated visibility across endpoint, identity, and email threat vectors.

- Designed Conditional Access and MFA policies in Entra ID that achieved Cyber Essentials Plus compliance and materially reduced identity-based compromise risk.
- Led security architecture reviews for multiple infrastructure and cloud migration projects, ensuring security was designed in rather than bolted on, and preventing the introduction of critical risks.
- Coordinated successful remediation of critical and high penetration test findings, reducing attack surface risk across public-facing and internal systems within agreed timescales.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)